EW 7 The translation of the word FOR

39. The translation of the word FOR in EXPRESSIONS OF TIME

i) referring to COMPLETED ACTIONS IN THE PAST : PENDANT

-he worked in Paris FOR four years :- *il a travaillé à Paris PENDANT 4 ans*

nb PENDANT can be omitted with:
rester (to stay, remain); *attendre* (to wait); *longtemps; un/quelques moment(s)*

-They stayed there FOR an hour :-*Ils y sont restés une heure*
-We played FOR a long time :-*Nous avons joué longtemps*
-I stopped FOR a moment :-*Je me suis arrêté un moment*

ii) referring to USE OF TIME IN THE FUTURE : PENDANT / POUR

-I shall go on holiday FOR a month :-*Je partirai en vacances PENDANT/POUR un mois*
-We will live in France for 6 months :-*Nous vivrons en France PENDANT/POUR 6 mois*

iii) referring to INCOMPLETED ACTIONS IN THE PAST OR THE PRESENT : DEPUIS

HAS been ....ing : *depuis* + present tense
-We have been reading FOR an hour:- *Nous lisons DEPUIS une heure*

HAD been .....ing : *depuis* + imperfect tense
-They had been waiting FOR a long time:- *Ils attendaient DEPUIS longtemps*

Recapitulation:

PAST	+ FOR	PASSE COMPOSE	+ **pendant**
FUTURE	+ FOR	FUTURE	+ **pendant / pour**
PERFECT	+ FOR	PRESENT	+ **depuis**
PLUPERFECT	+ FOR	IMPERFECT	+ **depuis**

Il a travaillé à Eton pendant cinq ans	He worked in Eton for 5 years
Il travaillera à Eton pendant/pour cinq ans	He will work in Eton for 5 years
Il travaille à Eton depuis cinq ans	He has worked (has been working) at Eton for 5 years
Il travaillait à Eton depuis cinq ans	He had worked (had been working) at Eton for 5 years

NB *Depuis* can only be used with the present and the imperfect tenses EXCEPT in NEGATIVE clauses where it is used with the same tense as in English:

I hadn't seen her FOR 2 days :*Je ne l'avais pas vue DEPUIS 2 jours*
We haven't rung them FOR weeks :*Nous ne leur avons pas téléphoné DEPUIS des semaines*

NB *Depuis* can also be used to translate `since' in examples such as:

He has been asleep since 10 o'clock in the evening	:	*Il dort depuis dix heures du soir*
I had been working at Eton since 1966	:	*Je travaillais à Eton depuis 1966*

40. Verbs describing bodily position

When translating into French words describing bodily positions you need to distinguish between

i) **the action required to get into the position** : rendered by the **reflexive verb**, eg. *s'asseoir, s'agenouiller*

(IN COMPOUND TENSES THE PAST PARTICIPLE AGREES)

ii) **the state of being in that position** : rendered by **ETRE + PAST PARTICIPLE** (with the past participle AGREEING WITH THE SUBJECT), eg. *elle était blottie*

	i) ACTION		ii) STATE
— to sit down	*s'asseoir*	to be sitting	*être assis(e)*
— to lie down	*s'étendre*	to be lying	*être étendu(e)*
or	*se coucher*		*être couché (e)*
or	*s'allonger*		*être allongé(e)*
— to kneel down	*s'agenouiller*	to be kneeling	*être agenouillé(e)*
— to crouch down	*s'accroupir*	to be crouching	*être accroupi(e)*
or	*se blottir*		*être blotti(e)*
— to lean ON	*s'appuyer SUR*	to be leaning on	*être appuyé(e) SUR*
— to lean OUT OF	*se pencher PAR*	to be leaning through	*être penché (e) PAR*
- to stand up	*se lever*	to be standing [the only one never to agree with the subject]	*être debout*

41. RESTER *assis(e)/étendu(e)/debout* etc.

This structure is to be used when you are stating or stressing the length of time spent sitting, lying, standing etc. Here you use RESTER.

They sit in this chair all day long	:	*Ils restent assis sur cette chaise toute la journé*
She lay on the sand for three hours	:	*Elle est restée étendue sur le sable pendant 3 heures*
She will sit for 1 hour without talking	:	*Elle restera assise pendant une heure sans parler*

nb RESTER may NOT be used with *depuis* which requires either the present or the imperfect tense

She had been crouching there for over an hour : *Elle y était blottie depuis plus d'une heure*

Recapitulation:

She sits down (assumes the position)	*Elle s'assied*
She is sitting (already in the position)	*Elle est assise*
She sits (all day long)	*Elle reste assise (toute la journée)*

42. TO BE STANDING/TO STAND

a) **PEOPLE**

— **for simple statements of position** : **SE TENIR** or **ETRE DEBOUT**

He was standing by the fire:	*Il se tenait au coin du feu*
Her husband was sitting but she was standing:	*Son mari était assis mais elle était debout*

b) **THINGS** : **SE TROUVER** (NB *se tenir* can ONLY be used for people)

The building that stands next to the station :	*Le bâtiment qui se trouve près de la gare*

43. EN TRAIN DE

Sometimes the verb describing the bodily position is followed by another -ING verb describing what the person was doing in that position : this is rendered in French by EN TRAIN DE + INFINITIVE

eg	She was sitting reading	: *Elle était assise EN TRAIN DE lire*
	He was standing next to me smoking	: *Il se tenait à côté de moi EN TRAIN DE fumer*